FORGE

A PLAN FOR A NEW FORGE CLASS

FORGE Your Future

(working name)

For men under 30

DRAFT FOR REVIEW BY THE FORGE FACILITATORS

Nothing in this plan is final. Mark it up.

Draft 1 · October 2026

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How to Use This Plan

This is a **plan**, not a finished class. No lessons, workbook, videos or forms will be written until you, the FORGE facilitators, have reviewed it and agreed on what fits here.

- **Read it through once** before you mark anything.
- **Wherever you see a "Your call" box,** tick a choice or write your own. Every box has room for something else.
- **Cross out anything that won't work here.** Write in the margins. Add what's missing. Nothing in here is settled.
- **The samples at the back** (flyers, a one-page overview, questions and answers, an interest survey, an application and a member pledge) show what the young men would see. They are examples to react to, not final copies.
- **When you're done,** fill in the Review Sheet at the end of the plan and return the marked-up copy.

What happens next

1. You review and mark up this plan.
2. The plan is revised to match your decisions, and the questions only staff can answer (Section 15) are asked.
3. The facilitator guide, participant workbook, flyers and forms are written.
4. You review those before the first group starts.

YOUR CALL **Who returns the marked-up plan, and by when?**

1. Why This Class

Of the **51,917 people in GDC custody, about 9,700 are under 30**, nearly one in five (GDC's weekly Friday report, October 16, 2026). Many of them are serving sentences longer than they have been alive. A 20-year sentence for a 20-year-old is a lifetime. Almost a fifth of the people in GDC custody are serving life, life without parole or a death sentence (GDC's monthly inmate profile, October 2026).

When the end is that far away, it's easy to believe nothing you do inside matters. Too many young men decide there's no reason to do good. **This class is built to answer that belief.**

Education is the clearest place to start. Of the men whose school level GDC has on record, **about half never finished 12th grade or earned a GED.** A GED is the first door. College is the next one, and it is offered inside: Ashland University's college program in Georgia prisons began at Dooly State Prison in GDC's 2019 fiscal year, and in fiscal 2023 GDC reported 38 bachelor's and 87 associate degrees earned by men and women in its custody.

FORGE already trains mentors. This class gives those mentors the men who most need them, and it gives younger men a reason to start growing now instead of waiting.

2. What This Class Is, and What It Isn't

It is:

- A short class for men under 30: about 12 weeks, one or two hours a week.
- A starting point: thinking about the future, getting a GED, then getting into college or a trade program, and building a record that shows growth.
- **On the record.** Completions of this class are entered in a man's GDC record (SCRIBE), the same as FORGE completions.
- **Membership, not just a class.** Graduates stay connected through a monthly members' meeting and a FORGE mentor.
- A way to change a dorm from the inside, one man at a time.

It isn't:

- **The FORGE mentor certification program.** It's shorter, lighter and asks less. Graduates who want to go further can apply for mentor training later.
- Therapy, a religious program, or a substitute for school.
- **A promise of parole or early release.** See Section 4.

YOUR CALL **Working name for the class**

- ☐ FORGE Your Future
- ☐ FORGE Forward
- ☐ Young FORGE
- ☐ FORGE Next
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

3. Who It's For

- **Men under 30** when they join.
- **Any sentence, including life.** Long sentences are the reason this class exists.
- **No GED needed. No clean record needed.** Building one is part of the point.
- **Men who choose to apply.** Nobody is sent to it.
- **He must live in the FORGE dorm.** The class meets there. Men in every dorm can apply. FORGE mentors and the chief counselor approve applications, and the chief counselor moves an approved man into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens (Section 11).

YOUR CALL **Age line**

- ☐ Under 30 when he joins
- ☐ Under 25 when he joins
- ☐ No age limit, but built for younger men
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

YOUR CALL **Group size (depends on how many FORGE dorm beds the class can hold, Section 15)**

- ☐ 8 to 10 men
- ☐ 10 to 15 men
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

4. The Message of Hope: What We Say and What We Never Say

This is the most important section of the plan. The young men we want will test every promise we make, and they will ask older men whether it's true. **If one promise turns out to be false, the class loses that man and every man he talks to.**

What the law says today

If the sentence is…	Parole under today's law	What growth can still do
Most other crimes (drugs, burglary, theft, aggravated assault and so on)	Parole-eligible. The Parole Board sets a Tentative Parole Month that depends on good conduct and sometimes on finishing a program.	It bears directly on whether that month holds.
A set number of years for one of the seven serious violent felonies: murder, armed robbery, kidnapping, rape, aggravated child molestation, aggravated sodomy, aggravated sexual battery	Served in full. No parole and no earned time. In his last year, he can be considered for a transitional center or work release.	The transitional center in the last year. Security level, transfers and job assignments. First in line if the law changes.
Life for one of those seven crimes	First parole consideration after 30 years.	The Board will read 30 years of his file.
Life without parole	None under today's law.	Only a change in the law would open a door. If one comes, the file is what will count.

Source: O.C.G.A. § 17-10-6.1; State Board of Pardons and Paroles. Some other sentences carry their own no-parole rules (for example, some repeat-offender sentences). When a man isn't sure where he stands, help him ask his counselor.

Laws do change

Other states have changed their laws to reward exactly what this class builds. California, for example, now gives time credits for education and rehabilitation programs, and gives earlier parole hearings to people who were under 26 when they committed their crime. Nobody can say whether or when Georgia will do something like it. But when laws change, the men who benefit first are the ones whose record shows they grew.

What we say

> Nobody can promise you a law will change. But laws do change. When they do, the men who go first are the ones whose file shows they grew. Start building yours now. And if the law never changes, a GED, college credits and a clean record still make you a different man, inside or out.

What we never say

- "FORGE will get you parole" or "This will get you out early."
- "They're about to let people out," or any timeline at all.
- Anything about a particular man's case or his chances. Send those questions to his counselor or a lawyer.

What's in a man's file

A GED, college credits, work assignments, programs completed, and his disciplinary record all go into his GDC record. **Completions of this class will be entered in SCRIBE,** GDC's record system, the same as FORGE completions. So a man can be told plainly: finishing this class goes in your file, and so do the GED, the college credits and the clean record that come with it.

When a man says "I've got life without parole. Why bother?"

1. Laws change, and the men with a record are first in line when they do.
2. However long he's here, who he is for those years is his to decide.
3. Men serving long sentences become the leaders of a dorm. The younger men watch them.

YOUR CALL **The message**

☐ Use "What we say" as written

☐ Change it (write your version below)

5. Goals: What a Man Leaves With

By the end of the 12 weeks, each man has:

1. **Signed up for GED classes or testing.** If he already has a GED, he has applied to a college or trade program, or is helping another man with his GED.
2. **A written 10-year plan,** with the next step for this month.
3. **Twelve weeks of clean conduct.** A goal, not a requirement.
4. **A FORGE mentor** he can go to.
5. **One thing he does for someone else** in his dorm.

YOUR CALL **Goals to add, change or drop**

6. Format

Option	Shape	Total
A. Recommended	Two 6-week parts, two 1-hour meetings a week	24 hours
B	12 straight weeks, two 1-hour meetings a week	24 hours
C	Two 6-week parts, one 90-minute meeting a week	18 hours
D	12 straight weeks, one 90-minute meeting a week	18 hours

Why Option A:

- **Part 1 is a small first ask:** six weeks, not twelve. A man can say yes to six weeks.
- **A quick win:** a certificate and a GED sign-up at week 6.
- **Part 2 is his choice.** The men who come back have chosen to.
- **An hour holds a young man better than two.** Twice a week builds a habit, and missing one meeting doesn't lose a whole week.
- **The second meeting each week is the working one:** GED study check, goals, time with a mentor.
- **A new Part 1 group can start every 6 weeks** while the previous group does Part 2.

Men arrive one at a time. A man can start only after he moves into the FORGE dorm, and beds open when other men move out. That happens fairly regularly, but not on a schedule. So the plan has to say how a new man starts.

YOUR CALL **How a new man starts**

☐ **Groups start every 6 weeks (recommended).** A man who moves in between starts waits for the next Part 1. Meanwhile he has a welcome talk with a mentor, starts his GED sign-up, and sits in on the working meeting (Meeting 2) each week.

☐ **Open entry.** Every week stands on its own. A man starts the week after he moves in and finishes when he has done all of the weeks, in whatever order they come.

☐ Other: _____

_____

After week 12: a monthly members' meeting and a FORGE mentor for each graduate (Section 9). A GED and college take years, not 12 weeks. Membership is what carries a man that far.

YOUR CALL **Format**

☐ A. Two 6-week parts, 2 × 1 hour a week

☐ B. 12 straight weeks, 2 × 1 hour a week

☐ C. Two 6-week parts, 1 × 90 minutes a week

☐ D. 12 straight weeks, 1 × 90 minutes a week

☐ Other: _____

_____

YOUR CALL **Best days, times and room here**

_____

_____

7. The 12 Weeks: Draft Outline

Each week has one topic. Mark each one **Keep**, **Change** or **Drop**, and write in what's missing.

Part 1: Your Time. Who you are and where you are.

Wk	Topic	What it covers	Keep · Change · Drop
1	**Doing time or using it**	The math of a long sentence. Hope as something you practice. What this class is and isn't.	☐ ☐ ☐
2	**Who I am beyond my case**	Values. The man I want to be at 30, 40 and 50.	☐ ☐ ☐
3	**Thinking under pressure**	FORGE's thinking tool, simplified: the moment between what happens and what you do.	☐ ☐ ☐
4	**Anger, respect and the code**	Earning respect without losing years. Walking away without losing face.	☐ ☐ ☐
5	**The people around me**	Influence, debts, phones and gangs. Your disciplinary record is your résumé.	☐ ☐ ☐
6	**Your file**	What's in a man's record, who reads it, what helps it. Part 1 certificate. GED sign-up done.	☐ ☐ ☐

Part 2: Your Road. Where you're going.

Wk	Topic	What it covers	Keep · Change · Drop
7	**"I was never good at school"**	How the GED works inside. Study habits. Getting past old shame about school.	☐ ☐ ☐
8	**After the GED**	College inside (Ashland and others), technical certificates, reading on your own.	☐ ☐ ☐
9	**The 10-year plan**	Goals and milestones across a long sentence. The next step this month.	☐ ☐ ☐
10	**Money and work**	Turning a hustle into a business. Getting hired with a record. Handling money.	☐ ☐ ☐
11	**Family from inside**	Being a son, father or brother from here. Writing the letter you've been putting off.	☐ ☐ ☐
12	**Changing the dorm**	Leading by example. Helping the next man. Graduation: each man presents his plan.	☐ ☐ ☐

The class uses FORGE's own tools and words, so a graduate who later enters mentor training already knows them.

YOUR CALL **Topics that are missing, or that should move**

8. What a Week Looks Like

Meeting 1: Learn (60 minutes)

- Opening circle: 10 minutes
- Teach, or a short video: 15 minutes
- Practice in pairs: 25 minutes
- One commitment for the week: 10 minutes

Meeting 2: Work (60 minutes)

- Check-in on last meeting's commitment: 10 minutes
- Working time (GED study check, the 10-year plan, reading): 30 minutes
- Mentor time in pairs: 15 minutes
- Close: 5 minutes

YOUR CALL **The weekly shape**

☐ Use as written

☐ Change it: _____

9. Membership

Young men join groups. This class should be one worth joining. Membership is what keeps a man connected after week 12.

Level	How a man gets there
Member	Joins a group and signs the member pledge at the first meeting (sample in the back).
Part 1 graduate	Finishes Part 1. Certificate.
Graduate	Finishes both parts. Certificate. Paired with a FORGE mentor.
Peer Leader	A graduate who helps run a later group: sets up, leads a pair, shares his story.
Mentor training	A Peer Leader can apply for FORGE mentor certification.

After graduation: a monthly members' meeting, about an hour, covering progress on the GED or college, one man's story, and one problem the group works on together.

YOUR CALL **Membership**

- ☐ Use the levels as written
- ☐ Member card
- ☐ Member pledge, said together at each meeting
- ☐ Graduation ceremony
- ☐ Monthly members' meeting
- ☐ Peer Leader requires: _____ months after graduating, with clean conduct

_____

_____

10. Getting Men to Join

This is the hardest part. Ideas, strongest first:

1. **Flyers in every dorm.** Five samples are in the back. Each one tells a man how to get an application. Replace them when they get torn down.
2. **The messengers.** Older FORGE men who were 20 once. Their own words go on a flyer (Flyer 5) and in a short letter handed out with the applications. Men in the FORGE dorm tell the young men they know in other dorms: at chow, on the yard, at work and at school.
3. **Counselors.** Counselors in each dorm can point young men on their caseload to the class.
4. **Ask first.** Hand out the interest survey (in the back) with the first flyers. Men join what they helped choose.
5. **A small first ask.** Six weeks, a certificate, a GED sign-up, and a completion entered in his GDC record.
6. **Membership.** Something to belong to.

7. **Topics they want.** The money-and-work week will draw men who would skip a class about character.
8. **Each graduate brings one.**
9. **Things only staff can grant** (Section 15): ask for them, but never promise them until they're granted.

YOUR CALL **Recruiting**

- ☐ Flyers in every dorm. Which ones? (circle on the samples)
- ☐ A FORGE mentor's letter (Flyer 5, and with the applications)
- ☐ Word of mouth from men in the FORGE dorm
- ☐ Counselors point young men to it
- ☐ Interest survey first
- ☐ Each graduate brings one
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

_____

_____

11. Joining, Step by Step

1. A man sees a flyer in his dorm, or hears about the class.
2. He gets an application, fills it out (sample in the back) and turns it in.
3. FORGE mentors read it, and if possible one of them talks with him for about 10 minutes: why he wants in, what he hopes to get, and the commitments.
4. **FORGE mentors and the chief counselor approve** the application, or turn it down.
5. **The chief counselor moves him into the FORGE dorm** when a bed opens. Beds open when men move out, which happens fairly regularly.
6. He starts with the next group (Section 6) and signs the member pledge at his first meeting.

YOUR CALL **Applications**

- ☐ Copies posted with each flyer
- ☐ From his counselor
- ☐ From a man in the FORGE dorm
- ☐ Turned in to: _____

_____

YOUR CALL **The 10-minute talk with a man in another dorm**

- ☐ It can happen before he moves. How:

_____

- ☐ Decide on the application alone
- ☐ Hold the talk after he moves in, before his first group
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

YOUR CALL **When more men are approved than there are beds**

- ☐ Waiting list, in the order approved
- ☐ FORGE mentors and the chief counselor decide each time a bed opens
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

YOUR CALL **Attendance rule**

- ☐ At least 10 of the 12 meetings in each part (about 85%, like FORGE)
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ A man who falls short finishes with the next group

_____

YOUR CALL **If a man quits the class or is removed from it**

- ☐ He moves out of the FORGE dorm
- ☐ He can stay if he keeps the dorm's rules
- ☐ Other: _____

_____

12. Who Teaches It

- **Two FORGE-certified mentors per group.**
- **Possibly** men in FORGE Phase 3 (Lead and Serve) co-facilitate as part of their practicum.
- **Time:** about two hours of meetings a week, plus about an hour to prepare.
- **A facilitator guide** will script each meeting, the same way the FORGE guides do.

YOUR CALL **Facilitators**

- ☐ Two certified mentors per group
- ☐ Phase 3 men co-facilitate
- ☐ How many groups at once: _____
- ☐ Facilitators who want to teach it (names):

_____

_____

_____

13. Materials (Written Only After You Approve the Plan)

To be written:

- A facilitator guide, scripted meeting by meeting
- A slim participant workbook
- Final flyers, the application and the interest survey
- Certificates, and a member card if you choose one

What we may draw from:

Source	What it is	Possible use
FORGE's own tools	The thinking, emotion and conflict tools from FORGE Phase 1	Weeks 3 to 5
Skills to Pay the Bills	U.S. Department of Labor, free, written for ages 14 to 21	Weeks 9 and 10
Money Smart for Young Adults	FDIC, free	Week 10
Thinking for a Change	National Institute of Corrections, free	Weeks 3 and 4
SAMHSA anger management workbook	Free, already on hand	Week 4
Short videos and talks	For example, Shaka Senghor's TED talk "Why your worst deeds don't define you"	Most weeks
Letters from FORGE men	Letters to "the 20-year-old I was," printed in the workbook	Every week
One book (optional)	For example, *Writing My Wrongs* (Senghor), *The Other Wes Moore* (Wes Moore) or *Letters to an Incarcerated Brother* (Hill Harper)	Read across the 12 weeks

Letters wanted. The letters from older FORGE men may be the most powerful pages in the workbook. If you would write one to the 20-year-old you were, put your name below.

YOUR CALL **Materials**

- ☐ Use the sources above
- ☐ Add: _____
- ☐ Leave out: _____
- ☐ Letter writers (names; first names only would be printed):

_____

_____

_____

_____

14. What We'll Track

- Who joins and who finishes each part
- GED sign-ups and GED passes
- College and trade-program applications
- Disciplinary reports: the six months before a man joins, compared with during and after

Only with each man's permission, and only as numbers, never names, in any report. These numbers are what will persuade staff to keep and grow the class. **They're also the only honest basis for ever saying that FORGE helps at parole.**

YOUR CALL **Tracking**

- ☐ Track as written
- ☐ Change it: _____

_____

_____

15. Questions Only Staff Can Answer

Before the first group starts, someone needs to ask:

1. **Beds.** How many FORGE dorm beds can men in this class hold at one time? (Chief counselor.)
2. **After the class.** Does a graduate stay in the FORGE dorm? Peer Leaders and the monthly members' meeting depend on it.
3. **The record.** Completions of this class will be entered in SCRIBE, as FORGE completions are. Who enters them, and how soon after a man finishes? Does finishing Part 1 alone get entered, or only the whole class?
4. **College and GED.** Which college programs (Ashland or others) and GED classes are open to men here now, and how does a man enroll?
5. **Certificates.** Can a copy go in a man's file?
6. **Flyers.** Who posts them in each dorm, and who replaces them?
7. **Graduation.** Can family be invited?

YOUR CALL **Who asks staff, and what else to ask**

16. Timeline

1. Facilitators review and mark up this plan.
2. The plan is revised. Staff questions are asked.
3. Materials are written.
4. Facilitators review the materials.
5. Flyers and the interest survey go up in every dorm. Applications come in, and FORGE mentors and the chief counselor approve them.
6. Approved men move into the FORGE dorm as beds open. The first group starts when enough of them are there.

YOUR CALL **Target month for the first group**

Review Sheet

Fill this in after you've marked up the plan, then return it with your copy.

Decision	Your choice
Name of the class (Section 2)	
Age line (Section 3)	
Group size (Section 3)	
The message (Section 4)	
Goals (Section 5)	
Format (Section 6)	
How a new man starts (Section 6)	
Days, times, room (Section 6)	
Topics changed or dropped (Section 7)	
Weekly shape (Section 8)	
Membership (Section 9)	
Recruiting and flyers (Section 10)	
Applications, the 10-minute talk, the waiting list (Section 11)	
Attendance, and a man who quits (Section 11)	
Facilitators (Section 12)	
Materials and letter writers (Section 13)	
Who asks staff (Section 15)	
Target start (Section 16)	

The biggest concern about this class

What's missing from this plan

Reviewed by

Samples

What the young men would see

Five flyers, a one-page overview, questions and answers, an interest survey, an application and a member pledge.

Every sample uses the plan's recommended choices (two 6-week parts, the working name). They will change to match your decisions.

Circle the flyers you like. Cross out what doesn't fit. Write in what would work better here.

SAMPLE FLYER 1 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW · NOT FOR POSTING

YOUR TIME IS SET. WHAT YOU DO WITH IT ISN'T.

A FORGE class for men under 30

- Get your GED. Then college.
- Build a plan for the next 10 years.
- Build a record that shows who you're becoming.
- Get a mentor who has been where you are.

HOW TO APPLY

Get an application from: _____

Turn it in to: _____

Approved? You move into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens.

FORGE Your Future

For men under 30 · Ask any FORGE facilitator

SAMPLE FLYER 2 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW · NOT FOR POSTING

YOUR FILE IS YOUR RÉSUMÉ.

The people who make decisions about you read it. What's in yours?

Laws change. When they do, the men who go first are the ones whose file shows they grew. **Start building yours now.**

- A GED
- College credits
- Clean conduct
- This class, entered in your GDC record

HOW TO APPLY

Get an application from: _____

Turn it in to: _____

Approved? You move into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens.

FORGE Your Future

For men under 30 · Ask any FORGE facilitator

SAMPLE FLYER 3 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW · NOT FOR POSTING

NEVER FINISHED SCHOOL? START HERE.

Your GED first. Then college. Inside.

Men in Georgia prisons earn college degrees every year. Every one of them started with a GED. You won't do it alone.

- Help signing up for the GED
- Study time with men who've passed it
- Then college and trade programs

HOW TO APPLY

Get an application from: _____

Turn it in to: _____

Approved? You move into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens.

FORGE Your Future

For men under 30 · Ask any FORGE facilitator

SAMPLE FLYER 4 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW · NOT FOR POSTING

TURN YOUR HUSTLE INTO A PLAN.

You already know how to work hard and take a risk. Point it somewhere that lasts.

- Getting hired with a record
- Starting something of your own
- Handling money
- Building something for your family

HOW TO APPLY

Get an application from: _____

Turn it in to: _____

Approved? You move into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens.

FORGE

FORGE Your Future

For men under 30 · Ask any FORGE facilitator

SAMPLE FLYER 5 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW · NOT FOR POSTING

I WAS 20 ONCE.

A letter from a FORGE mentor

[Sample wording. A FORGE mentor will write this in his own words.]

> When I was 20, I had a long sentence and I was sure nothing I did in here mattered. I spent years proving it. The men I came in with who got their GED, kept their record clean and found somebody to learn from are not the same men today. I started late. You don't have to.

— A FORGE mentor

HOW TO APPLY

Get an application from: _____

Turn it in to: _____

Approved? You move into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens.

FORGE Your Future

For men under 30 · Ask any FORGE facilitator

FORGE Your Future

A class for men under 30 who want their time to count

Who it's for

Men under 30. Any sentence, including life. No GED needed. No clean record needed.

How long

Two parts of six weeks. Two one-hour meetings a week. Finish Part 1 and decide if you want Part 2.

How to join

The class meets in the FORGE dorm, so you have to live there to take it. Fill out an application. If FORGE mentors and the chief counselor approve it, you move into the FORGE dorm when a bed opens and start with the next group.

What it costs

Nothing.

What it asks of you

Show up. Respect every man in the room. Keep what's said in the room in the room. Try the work, even when it's hard.

What you'll work on

Part 1: Your Time	Part 2: Your Road
1. Doing time or using it	7. "I was never good at school"
2. Who I am beyond my case	8. After the GED: college and trades
3. Thinking under pressure	9. The 10-year plan
4. Anger, respect and the code	10. Money and work
5. The people around me	11. Family from inside
6. Your file	12. Changing the dorm

What you walk away with

- Signed up for your GED, or applied to college or a trade program if you already have one
- A written plan for the next 10 years
- A FORGE mentor
- Your completion entered in your GDC record (SCRIBE)
- Two certificates, and membership that doesn't end at week 12

The honest part. No class can promise you parole. Here's what we can promise: do the work, and you'll leave this class with a plan, a mentor, and a record that shows who you're becoming. Laws do change. When they do, that record is what counts.

Questions Men Ask

Will this get me parole?

No class can promise that. If your sentence is parole-eligible, the Parole Board looks at your conduct and the programs you finish. If it isn't, laws change, and when they do, the record counts. Either way, a GED, college credits and a clean record change what you can do, inside or out.

Do I have to move to the FORGE dorm?

Yes. The class meets there. If you're approved, the chief counselor moves you when a bed opens. Beds open when men move out, which happens fairly regularly.

Does this go in my file?

Yes. When you finish, your completion is entered in your GDC record (SCRIBE).

I've got life, or life without parole. Is this for me?

Yes. You may be here a long time. Who you are for that time is yours to decide, and the younger men will be watching you.

I don't have a GED. I hated school.

That's exactly who this class is for. Men who hated school pass the GED every year.

I already have my GED.

Then the next step is college or a trade program, and you can help the men working on theirs.

Do I have to talk about my case?

No. This class is about where you're going.

I've got write-ups. Can I still join?

Yes. Building a clean record is part of the point.

Is this a religious program?

No. Men of any faith, or none, are welcome.

What if I have to miss a meeting?

Tell a facilitator. If you miss too many, you finish with the next group.

Will what I say get reported?

Members keep what's said in the group private. At the first meeting, facilitators explain the few things they must report, such as a threat to someone's safety.

What happens after 12 weeks?

You stay a member: a monthly members' meeting and a FORGE mentor. Graduates can become Peer Leaders and later apply for FORGE mentor training.

SAMPLE · INTEREST SURVEY, PASSED AROUND BEFORE THE CLASS IS BUILT

What Would You Want?

FORGE is planning a class for men under 30. Before anything is written, we want to hear from you. **Don't put your name on this** unless you want someone to follow up with you.

1. Your age ☐ Under 21 ☐ 21 to 25 ☐ 26 to 29

2. Would you come to a class like this? ☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

3. Tick up to five topics you'd want most:

☐ Getting my GED
☐ College classes
☐ A trade certificate
☐ Money and business
☐ Getting hired with a record
☐ Family and being a father
☐ Handling anger and pressure
☐ Staying out of trouble
☐ Writing letters
☐ Leadership
☐ Reading
☐ Something else:

4. Would you move to the FORGE dorm to take this class? ☐ Yes ☐ Maybe ☐ No

5. Which would you rather have? ☐ One hour, twice a week ☐ 90 minutes, once a week

6. Best time for you ☐ Morning ☐ Afternoon ☐ Evening ☐ Weekend

7. What would make you join?

8. What would stop you from joining?

9. If you want someone to follow up with you: Name _____ Dorm _____

Application to Join

FORGE Your Future · for men under 30

About you

NAME _____ GDC NUMBER _____

DORM AND BED _____ AGE _____ TODAY'S DATE _____

School

Highest grade you finished: _____

GED: ☐ I have it ☐ In GED class now ☐ Want to start ☐ Not sure how

Any college or trade classes? ☐ No ☐ Yes. What: _____

In your own words

Why do you want to join?

What do you want your life to look like in 10 years?

What's one thing that could get in your way?

What would you want a mentor to help you with?

Your commitments

Put your initials next to each one.

_____ I will come to the meetings, and tell a facilitator if I have to miss one.

_____ I will respect every man in the room.

_____ I will keep what's said in the group private.

_____ I will try the work, even when it's hard.

_____ I understand that I must live in the FORGE dorm to take this class, and that if I'm approved I'll be moved there when a bed opens.

_____ I understand that this class does not promise parole or early release.

SIGNATURE _____ DATE _____

For facilitators only

APPLICATION RECEIVED (DATE) _____ RECEIVED BY _____

10-MINUTE TALK (DATE) _____ TALKED WITH _____

Decision: ☐ Approved ☐ Not approved

FORGE MENTOR(S) _____ CHIEF COUNSELOR _____

MOVED TO FORGE DORM (DATE, BED) _____ STARTS WITH GROUP _____

Notes

The Member Pledge

Signed at the first meeting. Said together at the start of each meeting, if the facilitators choose.

> I am a member of FORGE Your Future.
>
> My time is set. What I do with it is mine.
>
> I will build my mind and keep my word.
>
> I will respect the men around me, and I will walk away when walking away is the stronger move.
>
> I will finish what I start: my GED, my education, my plan.
>
> And I will be the man the next one can look up to.

MEMBER _____ DATE _____

FACILITATOR _____ GROUP _____

Member card (actual size, cut out)

FORGE YOUR FUTURE
MEMBER

NAME _____

JOINED _____ GROUP _____

My time is set. What I do with it is mine.